

Before September 10

Session 2 homework — "Claude that does the work" Searcy Chamber of Commerce · Next session:

Thursday, September 10, 2026, 11:00 AM – 1:00 PM

This page's goal: by September 10, handing Claude a job should feel ordinary. Three small things get you there.

The whole list takes about an hour, spread across three weeks. The single biggest predictor of whether today sticks is whether you point it at something real **this week**.

1. Run one real chore through Cowork

One. A real one, not a practice one — something that was already annoying you.

Remember the three habits:

Describe the outcome. Point it at a copy. Read it before it goes out.

Pick one of these, or one of your own:

- Point it at the folder you've been avoiding and let it sort the whole thing.
- Turn a stack of receipts into one spreadsheet — the same prompt you used in E3 works on your own pile.
- Turn a page of job notes into a written estimate you could actually send.
- Ask your inbox: *what have I not answered that I should have?*
- Take the messiest recurring report you make and ask for it in one shot.
- Photograph six paper receipts with your phone, drop them in a folder, and ask for an expense summary.

Two reminders that matter more at home than they did in the room:

- **Copy the folder first.** Every time, until you stop thinking about it.
- **Small folder beats big folder.** Point it at the twelve files that matter, not the four thousand you own.

Write down what you did — bring this page back on the 10th:

What I pointed it at: _____

What I asked for: _____

What happened: _____

2. Use your skill three times, and fix it once

The skill you built in E7 is a first draft. It gets good by being used.

1. **Use it three times** on real work.
2. **The first time it gets something wrong** — and it will — don't rewrite it. Just say:

Add this to the skill: [the thing it missed].

3. That's the whole maintenance routine. Once, and it's right from then on.

If it doesn't fire on its own, that's normal and it's a one-line fix:

Update the skill's description so it gets used whenever I ask for something like this.

Check that it's live: open **Customize > Skills** and look for it with its toggle on. That list is the answer. (Typing / and the skill's name may also bring it up — but if it doesn't appear there, nothing is wrong.)

Would rather see one first, or write it by hand? There's a starter at tinyurl.com/petalstem26 — Dana's finished quote skill, plus a blank template with instructions. You don't need it, but it's there.

Never finished building it? Ten minutes at your kitchen table. Your worksheet from E7 is the hard part and it's already done — open Cowork, tell Claude what's on that page, and answer its questions. If it offers to test or evaluate the skill, say **"skip the evals, just make the skill."**

☐ Built. ☐ Used it three times. ☐ Fixed it once.

3. Bring one thing you wish existed

For September 10, don't bring a folder. **Bring an idea.**

Part 3 is where you build something that doesn't exist yet — a real, small, working tool of your own. Not a spreadsheet. Software.

Think small and specific:

- *"I wish I had a thing that priced my jobs so I stopped guessing."*
- *"I wish customers could fill out a page instead of calling me."*
- *"I wish I had a checklist that added up as I went."*
- *"I wish I had one page that showed me this week's numbers."*

The one I'm bringing: _____

Why it would actually help: _____

What we'll build together: Dana has a file in her folder called *wedding pricing scratch* — her real costs, how long every arrangement takes her, and a note at the bottom that says she's been charging three times cost and eyeballing the labor for eleven years, and thinks she's losing money on the big weddings. On the 10th we build her the calculator that answers it. And you'll build yours.

Worth doing, not required

Install the Small Business plugin. Remember the two words from Block 3 — a connector is a door, a plugin is a box of instructions. There's one built for businesses like yours, and installing it takes about five minutes:

1. Open the Claude app and go to **Cowork**.
2. Click **Customize** in the left sidebar.
3. Open the **Plugins** tab and click **Browse plugins**.
4. Find **Small Business** and click **Install**.

It arrives with a pile of ready-made jobs already built. Poke at it — you're not going to break anything, and anything it installs you can turn off in the same place.

*Note: installing it does **not** connect your email. That's separate, and you already did it.*

One more thing worth knowing: the email connection you made today isn't only on that laptop. It follows your account — so Claude can search your mail from your phone too.

Read this if your email wouldn't connect

If you're on **Microsoft 365 or Outlook**, you weren't able to connect in the room, and it isn't something you did wrong. Microsoft requires the person who administers your company's email to approve Claude once, for everybody.

Hand the page below to whoever runs your email. That's the entire job.

Two things to know first:

- If your business email ends in **@outlook.com, @hotmail.com, or @live.com**, there's no supported way to connect it. Everything else in this session still works — you'd just keep using the folder approach for email.
 - If you administer your own Microsoft 365, you *are* that person, and the page below is for you.
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✂ For whoever administers our email

Hi — I attended a workshop on using Claude (by Anthropic) for business tasks, and I'd like to connect it to my work email so it can search my inbox and draft replies. It needs a one-time approval from an administrator before anyone at our company can connect.

If we're on Microsoft 365: a Microsoft Entra Global Administrator has to grant one-time tenant consent for the Claude Microsoft 365 connector. Anthropic's setup instructions are here:

support.claude.com/en/articles/12542951-set-up-the-microsoft-365-connector

One thing worth checking: please include the write permissions. Writing a draft counts as a write, so a read-only grant would stop the part I actually want. Claude still asks me before it sends anything — sending cannot be set to run automatically.

If we're on Google Workspace: a super administrator allows it at admin.google.com under **Security** → **Access and data control** → **API controls** → **Manage third-party app access** → **Add app** → **OAuth App Name Or Client ID**, search for Claude, and set it to **Trusted**. It takes about 15 minutes to take effect.

There's no Claude app in the Google Workspace Marketplace, so the allowlist path above is the supported route.

Thanks!

Stuck on any of this?

Bring it on the 10th. Ten minutes before we start is a fine time to say "mine never made the spreadsheet" or "I couldn't get my skill to work." Somebody else in the room had the same problem, guaranteed.

See you September 10.